

Kestrel Heat Stress Tracker GitHub

Pages - How To

1. Make sure the cap is lifted to show the wind.
2. Attach the tail
3. You can handhold it, 1.5 - 2 meters above the ground, but preferable is on a 3-legged stand
4. Make sure it is set to record auto with 5 minute instances. Record for 1 hour
5. Set away from pedestrians
6. Keep track of clouds
7. At the end, in notes, write the context down
8. Export as CSV or as report with images kept
9. Email it to my email and Sophie's and Dr. Kinney's.



[Link to more information on the Kestrel Heat Stress Tracker on GitHub](#)

Step-by-step: Kestrel 5400 Heat Stress Tracker (new user workflow)

1) Unbox + first device setup (on the Kestrel)

1. **Install batteries / power on** the Kestrel.
 2. On the Kestrel, open **Options**.
 3. Set **Time & Date** (so logs export with correct timestamps).
 4. (Recommended) Set **units** and verify your key screens (WBGT/Heat Stress).
-

2) Decide how you'll connect (phone-only vs phone + computer)

You have three common paths:

- **Phone/tablet only (Bluetooth LiNK)**: easiest day-to-day field workflow.
 - **Computer export (Windows/Mac)**: for archiving and CSV exports; may use a **LiNK USB Dongle** (wireless) or **USB data cable** (wired).
 - **Remote viewing via Ambient Weather Network (optional)**: publishes readings to AWN with a configured device location (not a continuous GPS track).
-

3) Enable Bluetooth on the Kestrel (LiNK models)

1. On the Kestrel: **Options** → **Bluetooth** → **Bluetooth = On**.
2. Set **Conct (Connect) = PC/Mobile**.
3. Confirm the Bluetooth **Status** shows **Available** before pairing.

If your unit is *not* LiNK-enabled, you'll use the **USB data cable** workflow instead.

4) Install the smartphone app

1. On iPhone/iPad or Android: install **Kestrel LiNK**.
 2. On the phone: turn **Bluetooth ON** (and accept any permission prompts).
-

5) Pair/connect the phone to the Kestrel (in the LiNK app)

1. Open **Kestrel LiNK**.
 2. Use the app's **device/add/connect** flow and select your Kestrel when it appears.
 3. If prompted, approve pairing and permissions (Bluetooth access).
-

6) Record data (two modes you'll actually use)

A) Quick "Snapshot" (single moment)

Use this when you want one timestamped record of current conditions.

1. In the app, go to the **Measurements** view for the connected device.
2. Create/capture a **snapshot** (the app manual describes snapshots/export from the Measurements workflow).

B) "Session recording" (time series)

Use this when you want a continuous record over minutes/hours.

1. In the LiNK app, start a **Record a Session** workflow.
 2. Let it run while you're monitoring heat stress conditions.
 3. Stop the session when done.
 4. Review in **Stats** / chart views (trend over time).
-

7) Export/share from the phone (formats)

Export a session or selected measurements

1. In the LiNK app, open the session (or Measurements selection).
 2. Select which measurements to include.
 3. Tap the **share/export icon**.
 4. Choose export format:
 - **CSV** (best for Excel/Python/R)
 - **PDF** (shareable report-style output)
-

8) Transfer/export to a computer (Windows or Mac)

This is for longer-term archiving and batch exports.

A) Install desktop software

1. Install **Kestrel LiNK for Windows** or **Kestrel LiNK for macOS**.

B) Connect to the computer

You have two typical options (device-dependent):

Option 1 — Wireless (LiNK + USB Dongle)

1. Plug in the **Kestrel LiNK USB Dongle**.
2. On the Kestrel: **Bluetooth On** and **Conct = PC/Mobile**.
3. In desktop LiNK, connect to the device.

Option 2 — Wired (USB data cable)

1. On the Kestrel: **Options** → **Data Port = On**.

2. Plug the USB data cable into Kestrel + computer.
3. In desktop LiNK, connect.

C) Export format from desktop

1. In desktop LiNK, select the stored **data log(s)**.
2. Export logs as **CSV** for spreadsheet/analysis workflows.

9) Practical limits to keep in mind

- **Export formats depend on where you export:**
 - Phone app: **CSV or PDF** for selected sessions/measurements.
 - Desktop app: **CSV** exports for logs.
- **“GPS tracking” is not the Kestrel device logging a GPS path;** GPS/location is typically phone-/account-based metadata in connected ecosystems, not a continuous track.